

Practice I: Retrieving a Reference Corpus from Web of Science

Objective

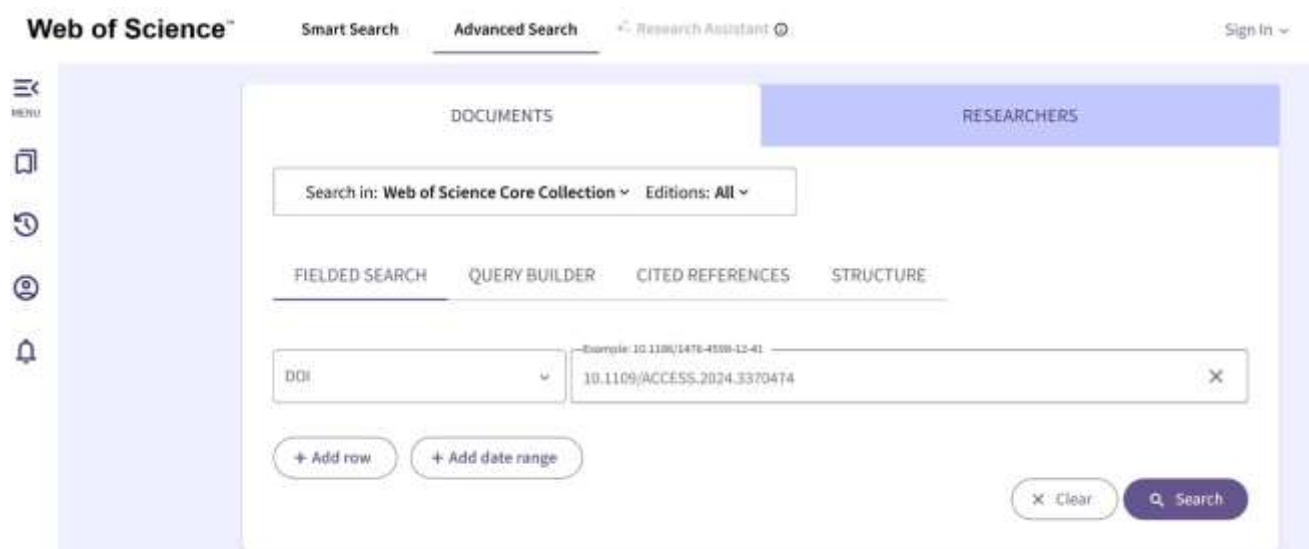
Construct a corpus of publications that represent the intellectual foundation of a research area by retrieving the references cited by a set of seed papers.

Step 1. Retrieve Seed Papers

Begin with a set of publications identified through a topic search, journal search, category search, or DOI list.

The screenshot shows the Web of Science Advanced Search interface. At the top, there are tabs for 'Smart Search', 'Advanced Search' (which is selected), and 'Research Assistant'. To the right of these tabs are links for 'Sign in' and 'Register'. On the left side, there is a vertical navigation menu with icons for 'Home', 'My Library', 'My Recent Searches', 'My Alerts', and 'My Account'. The main search area is divided into two sections: 'DOCUMENTS' and 'RESEARCHERS'. The 'DOCUMENTS' section is active and contains a search bar with the text 'Search in: All Databases' and 'Collections: 12 selected'. Below this, there are three tabs: 'FIELD SEARCH' (selected), 'QUERY BUILDER', and 'CITED REFERENCES'. The 'FIELD SEARCH' tab has a 'Topic' dropdown menu and a text input field containing the example search query 'oil spill* mediterranean'. Below the input field are two buttons: '+ Add row' and '+ Add date range'. At the bottom right of the search area are two buttons: 'X Clear' and 'Q Search'.

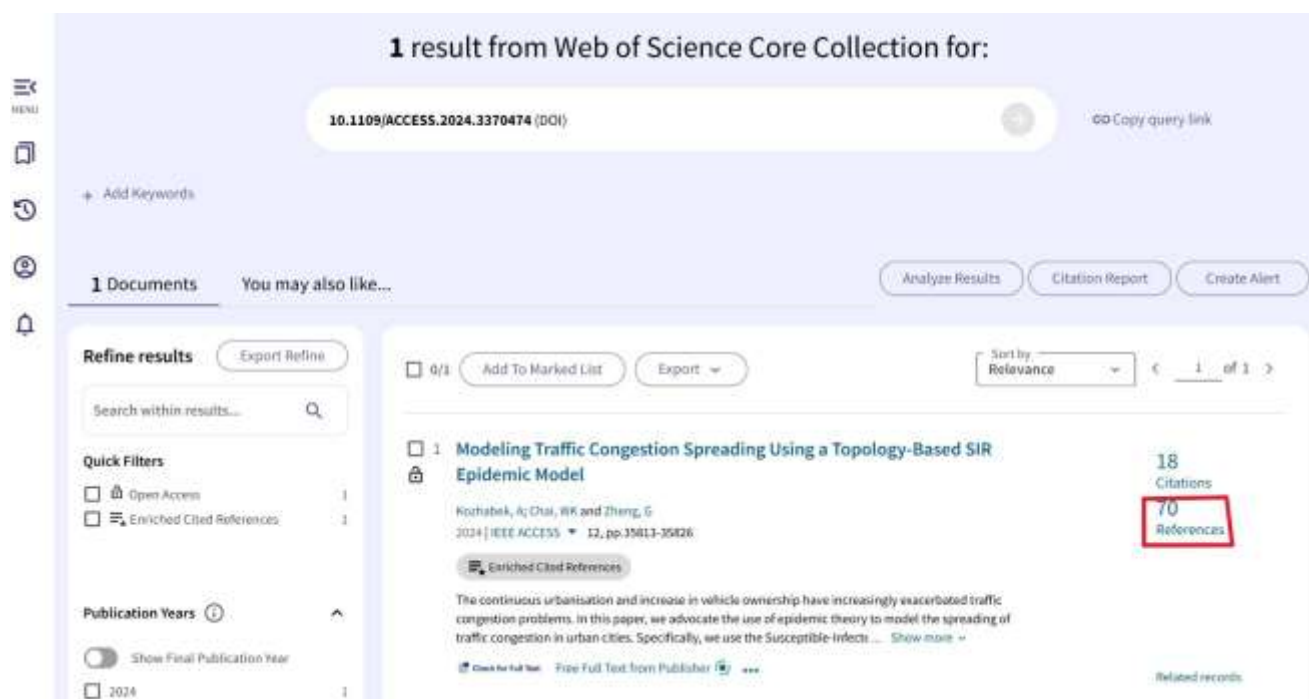
Review the retrieved records and select the papers of interest.



The image shows the 'Web of Science' Advanced Search page. At the top, there are tabs for 'Smart Search', 'Advanced Search' (which is selected), and 'Research Assistant'. A 'Sign In' link is in the top right. On the left is a vertical menu with icons for Home, My Lists, My Recent Searches, My Alerts, and My Profile. The main content area has two tabs: 'DOCUMENTS' and 'RESEARCHERS'. Under 'DOCUMENTS', there is a search bar with 'Search in: Web of Science Core Collection' and 'Editions: All'. Below this are four sub-tabs: 'FIELD SEARCH', 'QUERY BUILDER', 'CITED REFERENCES', and 'STRUCTURE'. The 'FIELD SEARCH' tab is active, showing a dropdown menu with 'DOI' selected. The search input field contains '10.1109/ACCESS.2024.3370474'. There are buttons for '+ Add row', '+ Add date range', 'X Clear', and 'Search'.

Step 2. Access the Reference Lists

For each seed paper, locate the **References** count displayed in the record.



The image shows the search results page for the document '10.1109/ACCESS.2024.3370474 (DOI)'. The page title is '1 result from Web of Science Core Collection for:'. Below the title is a search bar with the DOI and a 'Copy query link' button. There are buttons for 'Add Keywords', 'Analyze Results', 'Citation Report', and 'Create Alert'. The results section shows '1 Documents' and 'You may also like...'. On the left, there is a 'Refine results' sidebar with 'Export Refine' and a search bar. It includes 'Quick Filters' for 'Open Access' and 'Enriched Cited References', and 'Publication Years' with a toggle for 'Show Final Publication Year'. The main results area shows a list of documents. The first document is 'Modeling Traffic Congestion Spreading Using a Topology-Based SIR Epidemic Model' by Kozhabek, A; Chai, WK and Zheng, G, published in 2024 in IEEE ACCESS, pp.35813-35826. It has 18 Citations and 70 References. The 'References' count is highlighted with a red box. There is a button for 'Enriched Cited References' and a 'Show more' link. At the bottom, there are links for 'Check for Full Text' and 'Free Full Text from Publisher'.

Click **References** to view the complete list of publications cited by the paper.

Step 3. Retrieve Referenced Publications

From the references page:

1. Select all references that have corresponding Web of Science records.
2. Add the records to the Marked List (or select all available records).

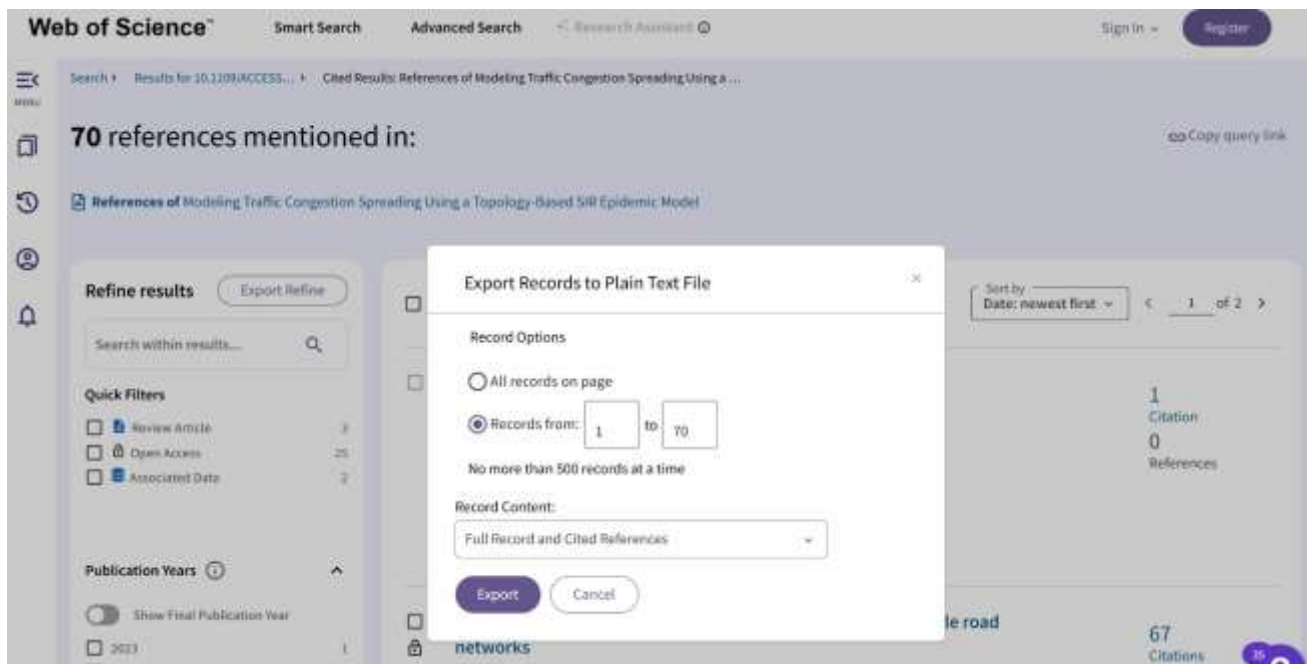
3. Open the resulting collection of referenced publications.

This collection represents the knowledge base on which the seed papers are built.

Step 4. Export the Reference Corpus

Select: Export → Other File Formats

Choose:



Record Content: **Full Record and Cited References**

Export the records as: Plain Text (.txt)

Save the file for subsequent analysis.

Step 5. Verify the Export

Confirm that the exported records contain the following fields:

- AU (Authors)
- DI (DOI)
- PY (Publication Year)
- SO (Source Title / Journal)
- CR (Cited References)

These variables will be used to construct network representations of the scientific literature.